RESEARCH MEMO · FALL 2024

Enrollment recovered. The latest growth looks different.

A concise research and publication-QA memo on U.S. nonresident enrollment at degree-granting U.S. institutions.

Fall 2024 provisional | 2015-2024 | 50 states + DC

BOTTOM LINE

Recovery is national. Its composition is not the same as before.

U.S. nonresident enrollment reached **1,044,137** in Fall 2024, or **5.31%** of enrollment in the analytic universe. That is **+63,400** students above 2015.

The newest annual movement breaks with the decade-level pattern. Undergraduate enrollment increased **+31,592** in **45 of 51 states/DC**, with public institutions contributing **+28,580**; graduate enrollment declined **-2,053**, producing a net **+29,539**. **R01 remains a fixed baseline:** call the shift broadly persistent only if the next complete release is positive nationally and in at least **26 of 51 states/DC**.

AT A GLANCE

Fall 2024
1,044,137

Change since 2015
+6.5%

2023-2024
+2.9%

High-priority QA flags
27

Manually reviewed
27

NCES benchmark checks
24/24

Three findings that matter

01 **The recovery became graduate-heavy**

Graduate enrollment is +138,765 above 2015; undergraduate enrollment is -75,365 below it.

02 **State recovery remains uneven**

33 states/DC are at or above 2019; 18 remain below. FL led the latest annual increase at +6,207.

03 **Institution-universe change does not explain the gain**

Continuing institutions contribute +66,981 over 2015-2024, while universe entry/exit nets to -3,581.

ANALYST JUDGMENT

Three flags, three publication decisions

HOLD THE ANOMALY

Community College of Rhode Island

+1,176 students · Hold institution-specific claim

Exact all-student totals corroborate the institutional frame, but the public source does not expose a comparable U.S. nonresident series. Keep the institution-specific claim held.

CORROBORATE THE DIRECTION

Collin County Community College District

+2,256 students · Publish with context

Official Fall reporting shows a large same-direction increase on a nearly identical enrollment frame. Keep IPEDS as the numerical authority and publish only bounded direction-level context.

EXPLAIN THE STRUCTURAL CHANGE

The College of Saint Rose

-115 students · Publish with context

An official closure record explains the institution's exit from the analytic universe. Treat the movement as a structural event rather than unexplained enrollment loss.

Methods and source trail

Primary measure

The series uses NCES/IPEDS Fall Enrollment `EFNRALT` for U.S. nonresident students. The analytic universe is degree-granting institutions in the First Look/Digest Title IV selection, located in the 50 states and District of Columbia.

Population comparability

IPEDS U.S. nonresident, SEVIS international-student records, CPS immigrant-origin estimates, and ACS-derived undocumented-student estimates answer different questions. The project maintains a separate population/source crosswalk before any companion comparison is attempted.

Release control

Historical revised IPEDS files are preferred when available. Fall 2024 is treated as provisional. Source URLs, archive sizes, retrieval records, and SHA-256 hashes are retained so later revisions can be distinguished from analysis errors.

Independent checks

All 24 NCES Digest consistency checks pass. State, institutional-control, and student-level aggregates reconcile to the national series, and institution entry/exit accounting is separated from continuing-institution change.

Publication QA

The latest-release queue contains 27 high-priority records. 27 high-priority records have evidence-backed manual dispositions; unresolved cases remain in official aggregate calculations but are withheld from institution-specific claims.

Use boundary

This is an enrollment-monitoring and research-QA product. It does not estimate causal policy effects and it does not convert one immigration-related population definition into another.

Portfolio research demonstration. Not affiliated with NCES or the Presidents' Alliance on Higher Education and Immigration.